ARENA SCHOOL
www.arenaschool.org

ACAMIS TECHNOLOGY CONFERENCE · OCTOBER 18, 2026

A case study from the INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校

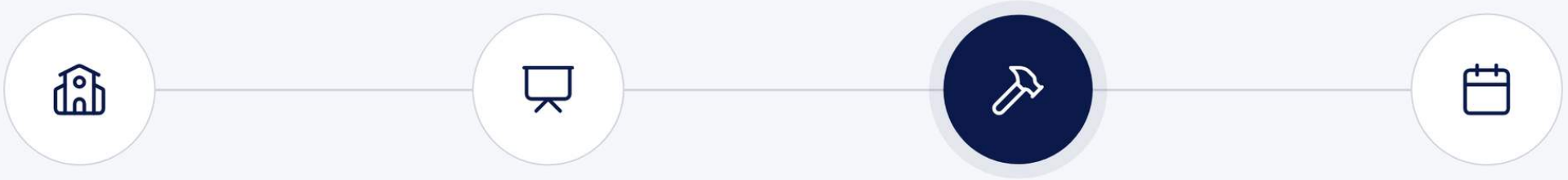
From Lab *to Classroom*

Running an AI Student Program Inside a School



Presenting at demo day, Beijing 2026

From how we teach *to what you can run at your school.*



PART 1

Who we are

Arena School, our philosophy, and our learning framework

PART 2

The case

The ISB AI Founders week, from day one to demo day

PART 3 · THE MAIN EVENT

Build together

What teachers build, then you name a chore and we build the fix

PART 4

Wrap-up

The big picture, three questions for Monday, and how to work with us

PART 1

We teach the part of learning *that AI can't do for you.*

Who we are, our philosophy, the research behind it, and our learning framework

1 Who we are
How we teach

2 The case
ISB AI Founders week

3 Build together
With the room

4 Wrap-up
Start on Monday

AI tools change every week.
We teach learners to make the calls.

MEMBER OF ANTHROPIC *Startup Program* OpenAI *Partner Network*

WHAT WE DO

Hands-on programs where every learner makes real things with AI.

HOW WE TEACH

- Learners make every decision
- AI does the building
- *Real work for a real audience*

WHO WE WORK WITH

- Students, grades 6 to 12
- Teachers and schools
- Parents and families

OUR TEAM STUDIED AT

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

OUR TEAM WORKED AT

McKinsey&Company · Goldman Sachs · Y · Microsoft AI · Deloitte. · KIMI

THE QUESTION WE TRY TO ANSWER AT ARENA SCHOOL

When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our students *still learn to do?*

Three human skills AI can't supply.
Without them, AI does the thinking.

01 · CHOOSE
Agency

Choosing what is worth doing, before anyone assigns it.

WITHOUT IT

AI picks the problem, and learners follow.

→

02 · JUDGE
Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good.

WITHOUT IT

Learners accept the first answer AI gives.

→

03 · FINISH
Craft

Finishing the work so people can trust it.

WITHOUT IT

The work stays an unchecked first draft.

This is how we teach every learner, from students to teachers and parents, *and the lens for today.*

Same AI, opposite results.
The design decides.

HIGH SCHOOL MATH · NEARLY 1,000 STUDENTS



–17% exam grades after practicing with plain ChatGPT. The tutor version largely avoided the drop.

HARVARD PHYSICS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL



2× the learning gains of an active-learning class, in less time, with an AI tutor built on the same methods

Bastani and others, PNAS, June 25, 2025: grades fell 17% once plain ChatGPT was taken away; with safeguards, the harm was “largely mitigated”; Kestin and others, Scientific Reports, June 3, 2025: 194 Harvard physics students, median learning gains more than double

AI helps at every step of the cycle.
Every decision stays with the learner.

01 Inquiry and planning

- **Which problem, for whom, and the plan**
- Suggests angles and drafts the plan
- *"Why this problem?"*

02 Research and evaluation

- **Which sources and answers to trust**
- Searches, summarizes, and compares options
- *"How did you check it?"*



04 Collaboration and reflection

- **What to change after critique**
- Gives a first round of feedback
- *"What would you do differently?"*

03 Creating and communicating

- **What to build, and what to cut**
- Writes the code, drafts, and visuals
- *"How do you know it's good?"*

THE LEARNER DECIDES · AI HELPS · THE TEACHER ASKS · *Then the next question starts the cycle again*

When AI can polish the product, *we assess the thinking behind it.*

THE PRODUCT

What AI can polish

THE THINKING BEHIND IT *What we assess*

IN PRACTICE *Used with ISB students, summer 2026*

Inquiry and planning

Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question.

Research and evaluation

Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output.

Creating and communicating

Build and test a product, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it.

Collaboration and reflection

Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work.

EVIDENCE WE ASSESS

Process journal

Drafts

Recorded defense

PART 2

In five days, ISB students built and launched *working products with AI.*

The program, the week, the tools, one student's build, and demo day

1 Who we are
How we teach

2 The case
ISB AI Founders week

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With the room

4 Wrap-up
Start on Monday

Pitching to the panel, Beijing 2026

An AI builder week for grades 7 to 12: *learn AI skills, start a company, build something real.*



Mentors in the room every day



Every team demos what works

7–12 grades, selected by application

5 days, at ISB in August

0 coding experience required

Ten stages in five days, *and every day ends with something real.*

	DAY 1 Pick a problem	DAY 2 Go public	DAY 3 The rebuild	DAY 4 Polish and price	DAY 5 Demo day
STAGES	*01* Find the idea *02* Validate it *03* Form the team *04* Define it	*05* Design it *06* Build it *07* Ship it live	*08* Test and iterate	*09* Brand it	*10* Pitch and sell
MAIN TOOLS					
SKILL TRAINED	AGENCY	TASTE	TASTE	CRAFT	CRAFT
OUTPUT	*A one-page plan and a first prototype*	*A live link that real people try*	*A rebuilt product, shaped by users*	*A name, a landing page, and a price*	*A two-minute pitch to judges and families*

Students learned 20+ AI tools in five days, *out of 200+ they could choose from.*

200+ AI TOOLS STUDENTS COULD CHOOSE FROM · 20+ THEY USED

RESEARCH
Ask and search

- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Gemini
- Perplexity
- NotebookLM
- DeepSeek
- Manus
- Grok
- Mistral

DESIGN
Logos and art

- Midjourney
- Ideogram
- Krea
- Recraft

BUILD
Apps and sites

- Cursor
- Lovable
- Replit
- v0
- Windsurf

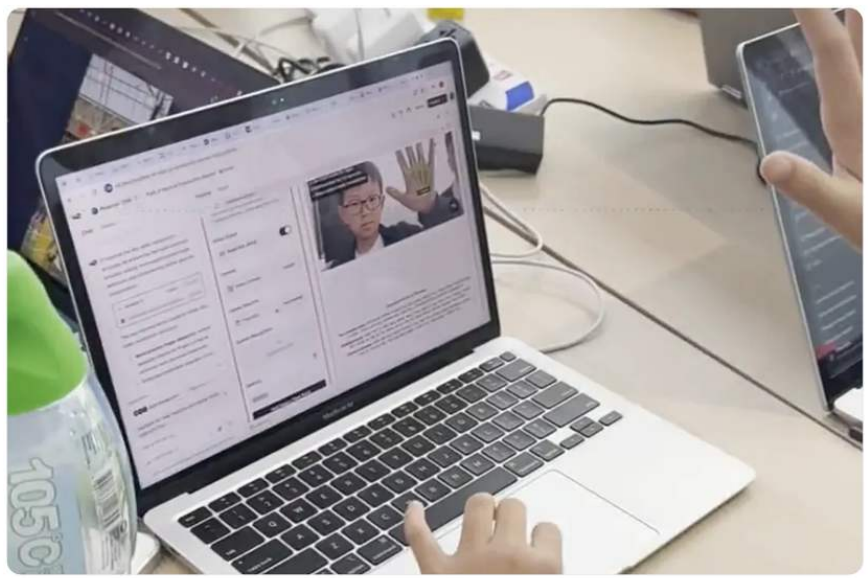
BRAND
Sound and video

- Suno
- ElevenLabs
- CapCut

LAUNCH
Sell and promote

- Stripe
- Pika
- Runway

In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



Built in five days by a seventh grader

01 Found the problem AGENCY

His cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it.

02 Sketched it AGENCY

Sign language in, spoken words out.

03 Built it CRAFT

AI tools did the building. He made every call.

04 Changed it TASTE

His grandmother couldn't use version one, so he fixed the audio.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- *Turn an interest into a focused question*
- *Build and test a product*
- *Use critique to revise the work*

On day five, teams pitched working products *to judges from Harvard, Stanford, Y Combinator, and AI labs.*



Judges test each product before scoring



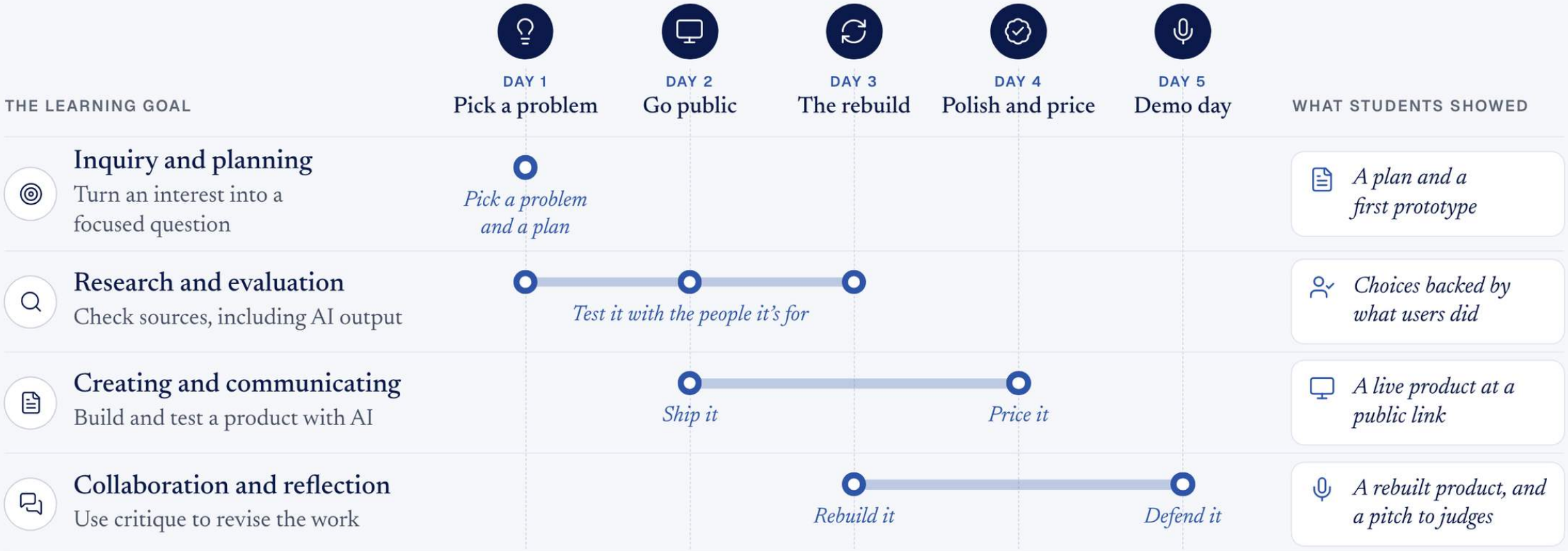
Every team pitched its own product



Teams defended their choices live

JUDGED BY FOUNDERS AND OPERATORS FROM HARVARD Stanford Y Combinator *and AI labs*

Every learning goal, practiced on real work *for real people, in five days.*



No worksheet and no quiz. *The evidence is the work itself.*

PART 3

Now let's build one together. *No coding needed.*

First what teachers already build for their own classes, then a build session with the room

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Walking the panel through a working build, Beijing 2026

Teachers don't lack ideas. *They lack time, approved tools, and a place to start.*

"We have no time for more PD."

- Start from one task you already do, and make the tool in the session.

"I'm not technical. Will I keep up?"

- No coding: you describe the tool in plain English.

"What about students using AI to cheat?"

- Assess the process: drafts, reflections, and the reasons behind each change.

"Our school restricts tools and student data."

- Use only the tools your school approves, with no student data in them.

AI gives teachers back time *to spend on their students.*

31% less time on lesson planning with AI in a randomized trial, with no drop in quality



5.9 hours saved a week by teachers who use AI weekly, about six weeks a school year

FROM A TEACHER WE SPOKE WITH

A grading timer, *not a grader*

Paper 9 of 24 — 4:12 / 6:00

An English teacher built a simple timer. It grades nothing: he still reads every paper and writes the feedback himself.

It gives every paper the same share of his time, and keeps his marking within a set limit.

AI handles the housekeeping. *The teacher keeps the judgment.*

EEF/NFER, randomized trial, 259 teachers in 68 schools (2024). Gallup and Walton Family Foundation (2025): weekly AI users, n=2,232, self-reported estimate.

Teachers don't need to code *to build for their own class.*

ENGLISH · FROM A TEACHER WE SPOKE WITH

Literary devices, one click away

SONNET 18 · LINES 5–7

METAPHOR

Sometime too hot the *eye of heaven* *shines,*

PERSONIFICATION

And often is *his gold complexion* *dimm'd;*

ALLITERATION

And every *fair from fair* *sometime declines,*

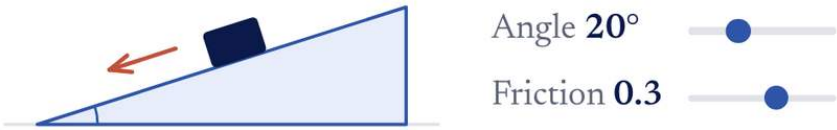
Instead of color-coding a poem by hand at the board, the teacher tags each literary device before class.

In class, one click reveals each device and its label.

Class time goes to discussing the poem.

SCIENCE · WHAT A STEM TEACHER CAN BUILD

A simulation made for this class



Students take a model apart and rebuild it, or change one variable in a physics setup.

Built for this lesson, not the nearest YouTube demo.

Students test ideas instead of watching one.

You bring a real school problem.
We walk through building the fix together.

STEP 1 · YOU NAME IT — AGENCY

A chore or a snag

A workflow you repeat, or a problem you keep running into.

- *"I rewrite the same parent email every week."*
- *"Tracking which students turned in drafts."*
- *"Making one reading at three levels."*

→

STEP 2 · WE BUILD IT — CRAFT

Claude Code writes it

An AI tool that builds web apps from plain English.

Claude Code *by Anthropic*

```
› Make a page where I paste a reading and get it at three levels.
```

→ A working web app, in minutes

→

STEP 3 · WE ALL ITERATE — TASTE

Open it, then improve it

We try it together and fix what's off, one plain sentence at a time.

- *"Make the buttons bigger."*
- *"Add a column for due dates."*
- *"Use simpler words for grade 6."*

PART 4

Start small, *and start on Monday.*

Your role as coach, the big picture, and how we can work together

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A team takes the podium on demo day, Beijing 2026

Your role becomes the coach, *and three questions do the coaching.*

THE TEACHER'S ROLE

From the person with the answers

↓

to the coach who asks the questions

It's what good teachers already do, and what our mentors did all week.

01
AGENCY

"Why this problem?"

They choose, not the AI.

02
TASTE

"How do you know it's good?"

They judge what it made.

03
CRAFT

"What would make someone trust it?"

They check it and finish it.

AI can do the making.
The thinking is still ours to teach.

1

Design decides

Same AI, opposite results. Learners choose, judge, and finish.

2

Students can ship

Live products in five days, with no coding background.

3

Teachers can build

Tools for your own class, described in plain English.

4

Start on Monday

One tool, one class, and three questions.

You don’t need to code. You already know how to coach.

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS WELCOME

Let's build this at your school.
We'd love to work with you.

WHAT WE RUN · *four pillars, one framework, planned with your team and run on your campus*

STUDENTS
Build and pitch a real product with AI
Entrepreneurship & AI Intensive
App Design Workshop
College Portfolio Workshop

EDUCATORS
Make the small tool your class is missing
AI for Educators
Conference workshops like today's

SCHOOLS AND TECH TEAMS
AI training that works inside your school's rules
Tech coaches and IT directors

FAMILIES AND COMMUNITY
Honest talks on AI, work, and college
Community Dialogues
Parent coffees and talks

KEEP IN TOUCH · *scan for today's materials, or reach us directly*

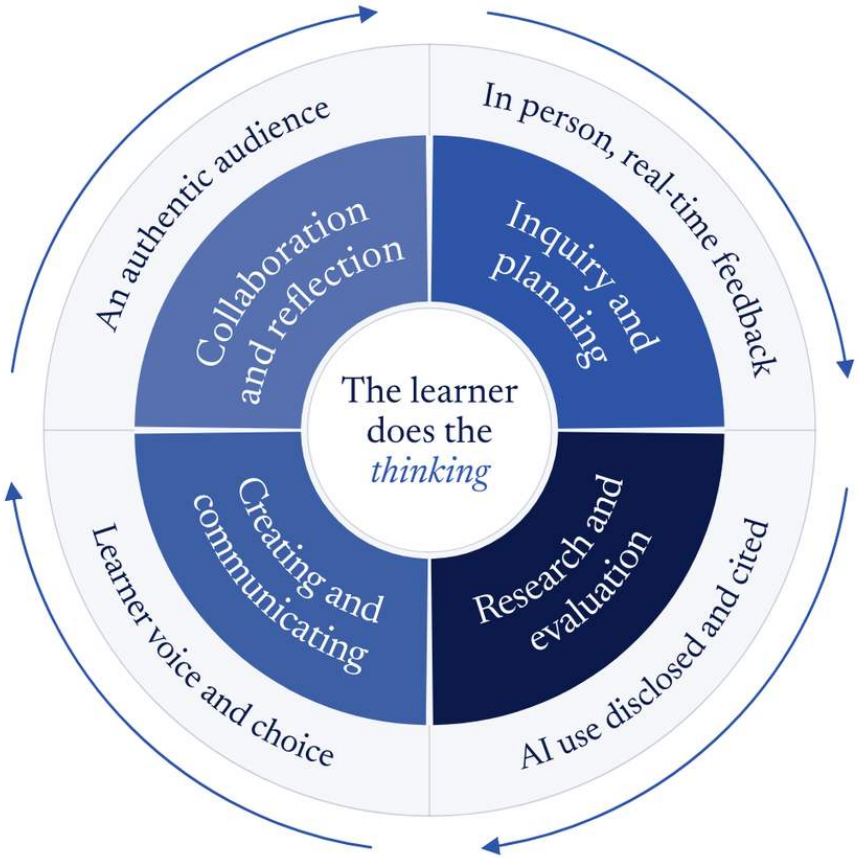
Today's slides, checklist, and tool guide
SCAN WITH YOUR PHONE

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MEMBER OF ANTHROP\C *Startup Program* OpenAI *Partner Network*

OUR TEAM IS FROM INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University · McKinsey&Company · Goldman Sachs · Y · Microsoft AI · Deloitte. · KIMI

Learners do the thinking, AI is a tool, *and teachers and peers give the feedback.*



BUILT ON PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

Every strand gets a real purpose and a real audience.
AI speeds up the building.

Informed by PBLWorks' Gold Standard PBL.

AT EVERY CHECK-IN, THE TEACHER ASKS

"How did you check it?"

and responds in real time.
AI can support that feedback, not replace it.

BACKUP · ALL LEARNING OUTCOMES

Across every program, *learners will be able to...*

Learners are whoever a program is for: students, teachers, school leaders, or parents. The outcomes stay the same; the depth grows.

Inquiry and planning	• Turn a broad interest into a focused, researchable question. • Plan a project with milestones, and adjust the plan based on progress.
Research and evaluation	• Find, evaluate, and cite sources, including checking the accuracy of AI output. • Compare options against criteria, and justify a choice. • Explain how AI tools work, where they fail, and the bias and privacy issues they raise.
Creating and communicating	• Build and test a product, prototype, or solution, deciding which steps to hand to AI and disclosing how they used it. • Structure an argument and write it clearly, in their own words. • Present to an authentic audience, and defend their reasoning under questioning.
Collaboration and reflection	• Work in a team, share roles, and contribute to a shared product. • Give and use critique from teachers and peers to revise their work. • Reflect on their process and on what they would do differently.

BACKUP · THE ASSESSMENT RUBRIC

We assess the process, *not only the product.*

SAMPLE CRITERION · RESEARCH AND EVALUATION

Evaluates sources, including AI output

BEGINNING
Accepts sources and AI output as given; cites inconsistently.

DEVELOPING
Checks some claims against a second source; cites most sources.

PROFICIENT
Verifies key claims, including AI output, against reliable sources; discloses AI use.

EXTENDING
Explains why sources disagree, corrects AI errors, and judges which evidence to trust.

EVIDENCE WE COLLECT

Process journal · Drafts · Recorded defense

IN PRACTICE
Used with students in the ISB AI Founders Program, summer 2026.

BACKUP · ONE FRAMEWORK, THREE KINDS OF PROGRAM

The same framework runs every program.

The learner and the output change.

	STUDENT SHORT COURSE AI Founders week	TEACHER TRAINING AI for Educators	CURRICULUM DESIGN AI in your courses
01 INQUIRY AND PLANNING	Choose a problem and pitch it in three minutes	Pick one task from a class you teach	Map where AI fits in each course
02 RESEARCH AND EVALUATION	Talk to the people they want to help	Check every result the tool gives	Decide when AI doesn't belong
03 CREATING AND COMMUNICATING	Build a live product at a public link	Make the tool on your approved tools	Write rubrics that assess the process
04 COLLABORATION AND REFLECTION	Defend every decision on demo day	Share the tool and the prompt behind it	Collect drafts, reflections, and reasons
LEARNERS LEAVE WITH	A live product and a pitch	A tool for their own class	A plan and rubrics the faculty owns

BACKUP · LOOKING BACK ON THE WEEK

The ISB week gave each skill *a moment students couldn't skip.*

01 Agency

Choosing what is worth doing, before anyone assigns it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

On day one, each student chooses the problem and pitches it in three minutes, with no slides.

02 Taste

Judging whether the output is actually good.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

By midweek, a prototype is online at a public link, and real users and mentors react every day.

03 Craft

Finishing the work so people can trust it.

HOW THE WEEK TRAINED IT

Building stops at a fixed hour each day, and on demo day students explain every decision live.

The build session runs the same loop *students ran all week.*

01

INQUIRY AND PLANNING

You name it

A chore, and who the fix is for.

AGENCY

→

02

CREATING AND COMMUNICATING

We describe it

To Claude Code, in plain English.

CRAFT

→

03

RESEARCH AND EVALUATION

We test it

Does it solve the problem for you?

TASTE

→

04

COLLABORATION AND REFLECTION

We revise it

Together, one plain sentence at a time.

CRAFT

Repeat until it's good enough to use on Monday

BACKUP · WHERE AI HELPS

Used well, AI gives every learner *more time for the thinking.*

FOR STUDENTS

AI does the making

So their time goes to choosing, judging, and finishing.

OUTCOME

Build and test a product with AI

FOR TEACHERS

AI takes the chores

So time goes to feedback, in person and in real time.

OUTCOME

Give and use critique to revise the work

FOR SCHOOLS

One framework for all

One rubric across students, teachers, and courses.

OUTCOME

Evaluate sources, including AI output

BACKUP · THE FOUNDERS OF ARENA SCHOOL

We build programs from inside schools, *and from inside the AI industry.*



Phillip An

CO-FOUNDER

Computer science at Caltech; MBA and master's in engineering at Harvard. McKinsey and Goldman Sachs.

Co-founded Homebase, the first company from Vietnam backed by Y Combinator. Forbes 30 Under 30; Schwarzman Scholar.

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Jing Jing Yang

CO-FOUNDER

Grew up at WAB and ISB. Economics and behavioral decision sciences at Brown; Schwarzman Scholar at Tsinghua.

Research with Microsoft AI; worked at Apple, Deloitte, and Kimi (Moonshot AI).

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BACKUP · WHY PARENTS CARE

Parents are asking one practical question: *which skills will outlast the tools?*

From surveying parents in the ISB community and other local communities in mainland China

WHAT PARENTS CARE ABOUT

Which skills last as the tools change?

Will AI do the thinking for my child?

What should my child practice now?

WHAT YOU CAN TELL THEM AFTER TODAY

Three skills outlast any tool

Used well, AI deepens thinking

Real products, in five days

Parents don't see AI as an academic subject, like learning to code.
They see it as a life skill: optional for many jobs today, and likely non-negotiable by the time their children start working.

BACKUP · IS USING AI JUST CHEATING?

No. AI tools write the code, *and students make every decision.*

AI TOOLS AND MENTORS HANDLE

Writing the code

Putting it online

Fixing technical errors

STUDENTS DECIDE

Which problem, and for whom

What to cut after users try it

The name, the price, and the pitch

BACKUP · PLANNING CHECKLIST

Your school already owns most of this.
Arena School can help with the rest.

YOUR SCHOOL OWNS

The learning goals and lasting skills

A five-day block on the calendar

Teachers, IT, and families on board

How students show their work

WHERE ARENA SCHOOL HELPS

Matching AI tools to each task

Prompting that builds thinking

Tools that work on your network

An idea to a product in five days

Checklist and China tool guide: arenaschool.org/talks/2026-10-acamis-tech-workshop

How we teach: arenaschool.org/approach